Local SEO checklist: 40 checks

How to set up, verify and run your Google Business Profile. Every check has a priority and a way to verify it. Version: November 2026.

Business _____ Review date _____

Reviewed by _____ Next review _____

How to use this template

1. **Start with the business details sheet** (page 2): one version of your name, address and phone number is the master for every other check.
2. **Work through areas A and B before you create the profile.** Don't change the name, address or category during verification.
3. **Mark a status for every check:** OK, to fix, or N/A (not applicable).
4. **Describe the problem in the notes:** what's wrong, who fixes it and by when, e.g. "old number in 2 directories, reception, by Friday."
5. **High priority first,** then medium and low. Check NAP consistency in the table on the last page.
6. **Fill in the log every month,** and go through the whole list again every quarter and after any change in the business.

Statuses and priorities

☐ **OK** – check passed

☐ **Fix** – to fix: note the problem, owner and deadline

☐ **N/A** – doesn't apply to your business; leave it out of the score

HIGH blocks setup, verification or visibility in Maps; do it first

MEDIUM limits results, but the profile works

LOW fine-tuning; do it alongside other changes

Review summary

AREA	CHECKS	OK	TO FIX	N/A	OPEN HIGH-PRIORITY CHECKS
A. Preparation	8				
B. Create and verify	7				
C. Complete the profile	8				
D. Reviews and posts	6				
E. NAP consistency and website	6				
F. Tracking	5				
Total	**40**				

Business details sheet (master NAP)

One master version of your details. Enter them identically in your Google profile, on your website and in directories (checks A4–A7, C1–C4, E1–E6).

Business name (as on your sign and invoices)	
Address line 1 (street and number)	
Address line 2 (suite, unit, floor)	
Postcode and town	
Primary phone (controlled by the business)	
Additional phone numbers (up to 2)	
Website (https:// URL, with UTM)	
Company Google Account (owner email)	
Primary category	
Secondary categories (up to 9, as few as possible)	
Business type	☐ storefront (address shown) ☐ service-area (address hidden) ☐ hybrid
Service area (up to 20 cities or postcodes)	
Opening hours	
Opening date (month and year)	
Business description (up to 750 characters, no links, prices or promotions): what you do, for whom, where, since when	

Verification and access

Method: ☐ phone / text ☐ email ☐ live video call ☐ video recording ☐ postcard

Date requested _____ Date confirmed (email from Google) _____

ACCOUNT (EMAIL)	ROLE	SINCE	NOTES
	☐ primary owner ☐ owner ☐ manager		
	☐ primary owner ☐ owner ☐ manager		
	☐ primary owner ☐ owner ☐ manager		
	☐ primary owner ☐ owner ☐ manager		

A. Preparation: details and account before you create the profile · 8 checks

NO.	CHECK AND HOW TO VERIFY IT	PRIORITY	STATUS	NOTES · OWNER · DEADLINE
A1	**Your business is eligible: it serves customers in person at its premises during stated hours or travels to them** **How to check:** Online-only stores, virtual offices and PO boxes don't qualify. A co-working office qualifies only with signage, customer service and your own staff on site during business hours.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
A2	**The profile will belong to your company's Google Account, not to an employee's personal account or your agency's** **How to check:** Create a Google Account with your company email address (it doesn't have to be Gmail). Give your agency or freelancer manager access later.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
A3	**You've checked that no profile for your business already exists** **How to check:** Search Google Maps for your business name and city. Unverified profile: select "Claim this business." Verified by someone else: request ownership (the current owner has 3 days to respond). Don't create a second profile.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
A4	**Your business name is exactly what appears on your signage, website and invoices** **How to check:** No keywords, city names, taglines, hours or phone numbers. Add a legal suffix (like Ltd or LLC) only if you consistently use it on signage and documents.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
A5	**You've chosen your business type: storefront with a visible address, service-area business with a hidden address, or hybrid** **How to check:** A plumber working from home hides the address and sets a service area. Show an address only if you serve customers there and have permanent signage with your name.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
A6	**You've written down one master version of your NAP (name, address, phone) to use everywhere** **How to check:** Fill in the business details sheet in the template. Use a phone number your business controls, a local number rather than a central call center where possible, and never a premium-rate number.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
A7	**You've picked a primary category after checking the businesses in the local pack, and secondary categories only for services you actually provide** **How to check:** The category should complete the sentence "This business IS a…", not "This business HAS a…". Search Maps for your main service and note the categories of the top 3 businesses. Use as few categories as possible.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
A8	**Your website is added and verified in Google Search Console** **How to check:** Google says this is one of the cases in which a profile can be verified instantly. You'll also need Search Console to track search traffic.	LOW	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	

B. Create and verify the profile · 7 checks

NO.	CHECK AND HOW TO VERIFY IT	PRIORITY	STATUS	NOTES · OWNER · DEADLINE
B1	**The profile is added at business.google.com/add or claimed with "Claim this business" in Google Maps** **How to check:** Adding or claiming a profile is free. Google doesn't charge for it.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B2	**The address and map pin point to the right building, with the suite or unit number on address line 2** **How to check:** Check the pin in satellite view before you choose a verification method. If you move, you'll have to verify the profile again.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B3	**You've chosen a verification method from the ones your profile offers and prepared for it in advance** **How to check:** Google sets the methods and you can't change them: phone or text, email, live video call, video recording or postcard. If you can, choose video: Google recommends it. Sometimes you need more than one method.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B4	**For video verification, you have proof ready: exterior signage, the street, equipment and access to staff-only areas** **How to check:** Live video calls are only available during your business hours, and you must be at the business. Show your sign or a street sign, branded equipment or tools and, for example, unlocking the door with your key.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B5	**While you wait for a postcard, nothing in the profile changes until you enter the code** **How to check:** Don't edit the name, address or category, and don't request a new code: the old one stops working. Most postcards arrive within 14 days, and the 5-digit code expires after 30 days.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	

NO.	CHECK AND HOW TO VERIFY IT	PRIORITY	STATUS	NOTES · OWNER · DEADLINE
B6	**Only you know the verification code** **How to check:** Google never asks for your code. Don't share it with anyone, including the agency that manages your profile. For phone verification, answer the call yourself: automated phone systems (IVR) can't receive the code.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B7	**Verification is confirmed by email, and the profile has a second owner or a manager** **How to check:** Google's review takes up to 5 business days. Add a second company account as an owner and your agency as a manager. For the first 7 days, a new user can't, for example, remove other users or become the primary owner.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	

C. Complete the profile after verification · 8 checks

NO.	CHECK AND HOW TO VERIFY IT	PRIORITY	STATUS	NOTES · OWNER · DEADLINE
C1	**The business description says what you do, for whom, where and since when (up to 750 characters)** **How to check:** No links, prices, promotions or keyword lists. Write for a customer who is seeing your business for the first time.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
C2	**Opening hours are accurate, and holidays and days off have special hours** **How to check:** Businesses that work by appointment only shouldn't list hours. Set special hours before every long weekend and public holiday.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
C3	**The phone number and website lead to this business: a number it controls and its own website with an https:// address** **How to check:** No redirects to another business's page or number. You can add up to 2 additional numbers. Googlebot must not be blocked on your site.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
C4	**The service area lists the cities or postcodes you actually serve** **How to check:** Up to 20 areas, within about 2 hours' drive of your base. You can no longer set a radius in miles or kilometers. Applies to service-area and hybrid businesses; a storefront that doesn't visit customers marks N/A.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
C5	**Your services (or menu, or products) are complete, and each item has a short description** **How to check:** List every service you provide separately: what you do, for whom and where. Complete, detailed information helps Google match your profile to searches.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
C6	**Photos: logo, cover photo, exterior with the entrance, interior, team and completed work** **How to check:** JPG or PNG, 10 KB to 5 MB, 720 × 720 px recommended (250 × 250 minimum), in focus and without heavy filters. Videos up to 30 s and 75 MB. Photos only appear after verification.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
C7	**Attributes and extra details are filled in: accessibility, parking, payments, opening date, social media links** **How to check:** Only tick attributes that are true. Enter the opening date as month and year. You can add one link per social platform.	LOW	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
C8	**Your profile is as complete as the profiles of the top 3 businesses in Google Maps** **How to check:** Compare the number of photos, reviews and services and the fields filled in with the profiles in the local pack for your main service.	LOW	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	

D. Reviews and posts: a routine, not a campaign · 6 checks

NO.	CHECK AND HOW TO VERIFY IT	PRIORITY	STATUS	NOTES · OWNER · DEADLINE
D1	**A review link or QR code is ready and sent after every job** **How to check:** Create the link in your profile. Email or text it on the day the job is done, or print the QR code on receipts or invoices.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
D2	**You ask every customer for a review, with no rewards and no suggested wording** **How to check:** Google Maps policies prohibit discounts or gifts for reviews, asking only happy customers, pressuring people on the premises and review quotas for staff.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
D3	**Every review gets a reply within 48 hours, including critical ones** **How to check:** Keep it short and factual, with no promotions and no customer details. You can only reply once the profile is verified. 48 hours is our working standard, not a Google requirement.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	

NO.	CHECK AND HOW TO VERIFY IT	PRIORITY	STATUS	NOTES · OWNER · DEADLINE
D4	**Reviews that break the rules are reported to Google, not “negotiated” with the author** **How to check:** Flag the review in your profile. Asking for a review to be changed or removed in exchange for a discount is also an incentive the policy prohibits.	LOW	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
D5	**Posts (updates, offers, events) go up at least twice a month** **How to check:** A new service, a completed job, a seasonal offer, a change in hours. Each post has a button linking to the right page. Posts older than 6 months are archived unless they have a date range.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
D6	**You add new photos every month** **How to check:** Completed jobs, seasonal changes, new team members. Your newest photos show first in your profile.	LOW	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	

E. NAP consistency and your website · 6 checks

NO.	CHECK AND HOW TO VERIFY IT	PRIORITY	STATUS	NOTES · OWNER · DEADLINE
E1	**The NAP on your website (footer and contact page) is in text and identical to the profile** **How to check:** Try selecting the address with your mouse: if you can’t, it’s an image. Compare character by character: abbreviations, unit number, postcode, phone format.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
E2	**The contact page has the address, a map, directions and hours, and each location has its own page** **How to check:** A location page needs its own content: team, completed work, directions. The same text with the city name swapped doesn’t work.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
E3	**The website link in your profile goes to the right page and carries UTM parameters** **How to check:** For example ?utm_source=google&utm_medium=organic&utm_campaign=gbp, so GA4 can tell profile visits apart from regular search results. With several locations, link to each location’s page.	LOW	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
E4	**LocalBusiness structured data in JSON-LD uses the same NAP and hours as the profile** **How to check:** Check it with the Rich Results Test. Structured data must describe what is visible on the page.	LOW	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
E5	**Directories, other map apps and social profiles show the same NAP** **How to check:** Check Facebook, Bing Places, Apple Business Connect, and general and industry directories. Add each one to the NAP table in the template.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
E6	**After a change of address, phone number or name, every listing is updated within one deadline** **How to check:** Start with the profile (a move means verifying again), then your website, then directories. Write down the date of each fix.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	

F. Tracking and profile reviews · 5 checks

NO.	CHECK AND HOW TO VERIFY IT	PRIORITY	STATUS	NOTES · OWNER · DEADLINE
F1	**Once a month you record your profile performance: views, calls, direction requests and website clicks** **How to check:** Profile → Performance. Write the numbers in the template log and compare month to month.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
F2	**You check your Google Maps ranking for 3–5 keywords from several locations, not just your office** **How to check:** Results depend on how far away the searcher is, so a single check next to your office looks better than reality. Note the keyword, location and date.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
F3	**Changes from Google and from users are reviewed and accepted or corrected** **How to check:** Check your profile for Google updates and for information Google has collected, including from automated calls and texts to your business number.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
F4	**Once a month you check whether ChatGPT, Gemini and Perplexity recommend your business for customer questions** **How to check:** Ask the same 3–5 questions, such as “can you recommend a plumber in Mokotów?”. Note whether your business is named and where the links lead.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
F5	**The profile gets a full review every quarter and before any change in the business** **How to check:** Hours, services, photos, owners and managers. Remove access for people who no longer work with the business.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	

NAP consistency: listings table (checks E1–E6)

For each listing, tick whether the name, address and phone number match the master version on the business details sheet. Describe any difference in the last column.

LISTING	URL OR ACCOUNT	NAME	ADDRESS	PHONE	WHAT TO FIX · DATE FIXED
Google Business Profile		☐	☐	☐	
Website: footer		☐	☐	☐	
Website: contact page		☐	☐	☐	
LocalBusiness structured data		☐	☐	☐	
Facebook		☐	☐	☐	
Bing Places		☐	☐	☐	
Apple Business Connect		☐	☐	☐	
Directory:		☐	☐	☐	
Industry directory:		☐	☐	☐	
		☐	☐	☐	
		☐	☐	☐	

Monthly log (checks F1–F4)

Numbers from the Performance tab of your profile. Record your Maps ranking for the same keyword and the same locations every month.

MONTH	VIEWS	CALLS	DIRECTIONS	WEBSITE CLICKS	NEW REVIEWS / REPLIES	POSTS / PHOTOS	MAPS RANKING (KEYWORD, LOCATION)	RECOMMENDED BY AI (YES / NO)

Latest version of the checklist, a completed example and Google sources: **www.ai-seo-company.pl/en/tools/local-seo-checklist**

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